ADOVA SYNAPSE · FRACTIONAL AI OFFICER

AI Opportunity Assessment

A sample of the exact deliverable you receive for the $1,500 assessment. Fictional client, real methodology and math.

Sample report. Pioneer Mechanical is a fictional company used to show exactly what you receive for the $1,500 AI Opportunity Assessment. The methodology, the math, and the pricing are real. Every dollar figure is modeled on conservative, defensible assumptions with the work shown so you can check it.

AI Opportunity Assessment

Prepared for: Pioneer Mechanical Services, Inc. (illustrative) **Prepared by:** Eli Abraham, Adova Synapse, Fractional AI Officer **Engagement:** AI Opportunity Assessment ($1,500, one-time) **Date:** Sample dated 2026-06-02 **Walkthrough call:** 30 minutes, scheduled after delivery

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1. Executive Summary

Pioneer Mechanical is a regional commercial HVAC and mechanical services company: roughly 120 employees, about $18M in annual revenue, ~45 service technicians, a 9-person inside office (dispatch, service coordinators, AP/AR, two estimators), and an outside sales team of 4. Over the past two years the company bought into AI and automation in pieces. A ChatGPT Team plan, a handful of Zapier zaps somebody in the office built, a CRM that holds maybe 60% of the real pipeline, and a phone system that drops or voicemails an unknown number of inbound service calls. None of it is owned by anyone technical. There is no map of what is running, what it costs, or what it is worth.

I spent 2.5 hours on-site and on calls with dispatch, the two estimators, the AP lead, and the service manager. What I found is normal for a company this size and this profitable: the operation works, but it leaks. The five opportunities below add up to a conservative **$168,800 per year** in combined cost savings and new gross margin. Strip out everything soft and you are still left with a hard-cash floor: roughly **$3,500 per year** in subscriptions and labor you can cancel or reclaim immediately, plus the recurring maintenance and inbound revenue the systems are built to capture. The biggest single item, missed and slow-answered inbound service calls, is also the easiest to fix and would pay for a full year of my retainer by itself. Against a $1,500 assessment fee, even the full conservative number is many multiples of the cost, but I would rather you judge it on the floor than the multiple.

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2. Current-State AI and Tool-Stack Map

Here is everything you are currently paying for that touches AI, automation, or the systems those would plug into. The "Owner" column is the important one. **Nobody technical owns any of it.**

Tool / System	What it does today	Monthly cost	Annual cost	Owner
ChatGPT Team (5 seats)	Estimators and 1 salesperson use it ad hoc for emails and scope writeups. No shared prompts, no process.	$125	$1,500	Nobody (Sarah in estimating set it up)
ServiceTitan-style field CRM	Work orders, dispatch, invoicing. Core system, but ~40% of new leads never get entered.	$1,950	$23,400	Service manager (uses it, doesn't administer it)
Zapier (Pro)	~6 zaps. 2 are broken (silently). 1 duplicates contacts.	$69	$828	Nobody (built by a former office hire who left)
Business VOIP / phone system	Inbound service + sales line. No call tracking, no after-hours capture beyond voicemail.	$240	$2,880	Office manager (billing only)
Email marketing tool	Used ~twice last year. Effectively dormant.	$80	$960	Nobody
QuickBooks + manual AP	AP lead keys in vendor invoices by hand, ~300/mo.	$200	$2,400	AP lead
Shared inbox (service@)	Inbound service requests by email, triaged manually by 1 coordinator.	included	,	Dispatch
Totals (AI/ automation-adjacent spend)		**~$2,664/ mo**	**~$31,968/ yr**	**No single technical owner**

Two findings worth calling out before the opportunities:

1. **Two of your six Zapier automations have been silently failing.** One was supposed to push web-form leads into the CRM. It has been dead since roughly February. That means a slice of your inbound has been going nowhere, which connects directly to Opportunity A below.

2. **You are paying ~$32K/year for this stack and cannot, today, get a one-page answer on what any of it returns.** That is not a Pioneer problem. It is the default state of every $10M-$30M company that bought tools faster than it bought an owner for them. That gap is the whole reason this role exists.

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3. The Opportunities

Five opportunities, ranked later in the prioritization matrix. Each shows the problem, the solution grounded in specific tools, the implementation effort (Small / Medium / Large plus rough weeks), and a dollar estimate with the assumptions written out so you can check or argue with the math.

Opportunity A: Stop bleeding inbound service calls (REVENUE)

The problem. Your service line and web form are your front door, and the door doesn't fully close. Dispatch told me they "definitely" miss calls during lunch, after 5pm, and any time both coordinators are on the phone. The dead Zapier form-to-CRM link means web leads have partly vanished since February. Nobody can tell me your answer rate or your missed-call count, because nothing is tracked. For a commercial mechanical company, a missed inbound is frequently a service ticket or a maintenance-contract lead worth real money, and the customer just calls the next contractor.

The solution. An AI voice + intake layer in front of the existing phone and form system. An AI receptionist (built on a voice agent that books and qualifies, wired through n8n into the CRM) answers on the first ring 24/7, captures caller, property, issue, and urgency, books routine service straight onto the dispatch board, and texts a human for true emergencies. Rebuild the web-form-to-CRM automation properly in n8n with failure alerting so a broken link pages someone instead of silently eating leads. Add call tracking so you finally see answer rate and missed-call recovery.

Effort. Medium, ~3-4 weeks. Voice agent infra and the field-CRM integration are the work; the form fix is a day.

Dollar estimate (conservative): +$66,000/year in recovered gross margin. Assumptions, all deliberately low: - Pioneer takes ~50 inbound service/sales contacts per business day across phone and form (dispatch's own rough estimate; this is a $18M services business). - Assume only **6%** are currently missed or effectively lost (lunch, after-hours, both-lines-busy, dead form link). That is ~3 per day, ~750/year. - Assume the AI layer recovers **half** of those, ~375/year. - Assume only **1 in 5** recovered contacts becomes actual booked work (a single dispatched service call or a maintenance lead), = 75 jobs/year. - Assume an average recovered job of just **$1,750 revenue** at a **50%** gross margin = $875 margin per job. - 75 × $875 = **$65,625/year**, rounded to ~$66,000. Anything better than these floor assumptions only grows it.

Opportunity B: Estimator turnaround time on quotes (REVENUE)

The problem. Your two estimators each told me the same thing: they are buried, and quotes that take more than a couple days go cold. Right now a commercial quote means manually pulling scope notes, re-keying equipment specs, writing the narrative, and formatting the proposal. Both estimators already paste pieces into ChatGPT with no shared process, so the tool is half-used and inconsistent. Slow quotes lose bids you would otherwise win.

The solution. A standardized AI estimating-assist workflow. A Claude-API-backed proposal drafter with Pioneer's own templates, pricing language, and past-won-quote examples baked in, fed from the estimator's scope notes, producing a near-final proposal draft and scope narrative for the estimator to review and send. Shared, version-controlled prompts so both estimators work the same way. This does not replace the estimator's judgment, it removes the typing and formatting hours.

Effort. Small-to-Medium, ~2 weeks.

Dollar estimate (conservative): +$31,200/year, split between recovered capacity and won bids. Assumptions: - 2 estimators. Assume the workflow saves each **5 hours/week** of drafting/formatting (they each estimated "at least a day a week"; I am using less). = 10 hrs/week, ~500 hrs/year of skilled capacity returned. - Value that capacity conservatively at a **$40/hour** fully-loaded cost = $20,000/year in reclaimed labor. - Win-rate lift: assume faster, more polished quotes win just **2 extra commercial jobs per year** at $14,000 average revenue and a low **40%** margin = 2 × $5,600 = $11,200/year. - Total ~**$31,200/year**. (The win-rate half is the bonus; the labor half alone justifies the build.)

Opportunity C: Automated AP invoice intake (COST SAVINGS)

The problem. Your AP lead hand-keys roughly 300 vendor invoices a month from PDFs and emails into QuickBooks. It is accurate but slow, it is a single point of failure when she is out, and it is exactly the kind of work that does not need a human's hands on it.

The solution. An AI document-intake pipeline. Invoices hit a dedicated inbox, an n8n flow runs each through a Claude-API extraction step (vendor, invoice number, amount, line items, PO match), validates against open POs, and pushes a ready-to-approve entry into QuickBooks. The AP lead moves from typing to reviewing exceptions only.

Effort. Medium, ~3 weeks.

Dollar estimate (conservative): +$15,600/year in reclaimed labor. Assumptions: - 300 invoices/month × 12 = 3,600/year. - Assume each currently takes **8 minutes** of hands-on keying and filing = 480 hours/year. - Assume automation removes **75%** of that hands-on time (the rest is exception review) = 360 hours/year saved. - Value at a fully-loaded AP labor cost of **~$28/hour** = ~$10,080/year, plus conservatively **$5,500/year** in avoided late fees and faster early-pay discount capture that the AP lead said get missed when she is behind. - Total ~**$15,600/year**, before counting the risk reduction of not having AP frozen when one person is on vacation.

Opportunity D: Maintenance-contract renewal and reactivation engine (REVENUE)

The problem. Pioneer has a large base of past commercial customers and a stack of maintenance agreements, but renewals and reactivations happen only when someone remembers. There is no systematic nurture. The dormant email tool is proof: you bought the channel and never used it. Your most profitable revenue, recurring maintenance contracts, is being left to memory.

The solution. An automated renewal and reactivation engine in GoHighLevel. Pull the customer and contract data out of the CRM, build segmented sequences (contract expiring in 60/30/15 days, lapsed-maintenance customers, customers with aging equipment), and run multi-touch email + SMS that routes interested replies straight to a salesperson. This is bread-and-butter GHL automation and it runs continuously once built.

Effort. Small-to-Medium, ~2-3 weeks.

Dollar estimate (conservative): +$48,000/year in recurring maintenance margin. Assumptions: - Assume a reachable base of **600** past/expiring commercial maintenance customers (low for a 120-person regional shop). - Assume systematic nurture lands just **20 additional maintenance agreements per year** that would otherwise have lapsed or never renewed (a ~3.3% action rate on the base, deliberately modest). - Assume an average maintenance agreement of **$6,000/year** at a **40%** gross margin = $2,400 margin each. - 20 × $2,400 = **$48,000/year**, and because these are recurring, the real value compounds in years 2 and 3.

Opportunity E: Kill the dead stack and consolidate (COST SAVINGS)

The problem. You are paying for tools that do nothing or duplicate each other. The standalone email tool ($960/yr) is dormant and its job gets absorbed by the GHL engine in Opportunity D. Two Zapier zaps are broken and one duplicates contacts; the surviving useful automations move into n8n on infrastructure you already have access to through me, which lets you drop the Zapier Pro plan ($828/yr). There is also a duplicate-contact cleanup that is costing your team manual reconciliation time.

The solution. A clean kill list executed during onboarding: cancel the dormant email tool, retire Zapier once its live zaps are rebuilt in n8n, de-duplicate the CRM. Pure subtraction.

Effort. Small, ~1 week (mostly done during onboarding).

Dollar estimate (conservative): +$8,000/year. Assumptions: - Direct subscription savings: $960 (email tool) + $828 (Zapier) = $1,788/year hard cost removed. This piece is guaranteed the day we cancel. - Plus the CRM duplicate problem and broken-zap babysitting: dispatch and office staff lose time reconciling duplicate and missing records. Assume just **4 hours/week** across the team at a blended **$30/hour** = ~$6,240/year of reclaimed labor. - Total ~**$8,000/year**. The subscription cuts ($1,788) are hard cash you stop spending on day one; the labor recovery is the larger, shown-math piece. I am deliberately not double-counting the recovered form-lead value here, since that revenue is already captured under Opportunity A.

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4. Prioritization Matrix (Impact vs Effort)

Impact = annual dollar value. Effort = build complexity and weeks.

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      HIGH IMPACT
          ^
   (A) Inbound call    |   (D) Renewal
       recovery $66K   |       engine $48K
       MED effort      |       S/M effort
          |            |
 ---------+----------+----------+-------->
  HIGH    |          |          |   LOW
  EFFORT  |          |          |   EFFORT
          |   (C) AP intake     |
          |       $15.6K        |   (E) Kill stack
          |       MED effort    |       $8K
          |                     |   (B) Estimator
          |                     |       assist $31.2K
          v                     |       S/M effort
      LOW IMPACT
```

Plain-language read: - **Do first (high impact, low/medium effort):** D (Renewal engine) and B (Estimator assist). High return, fast builds, low risk. - **Anchor build (highest impact, medium effort):** A (Inbound call recovery). Biggest single number, worth the extra weeks. - **Quick wins to bank early:** E (Kill the dead stack). Done during onboarding, pure savings, builds trust fast. - **Steady build:** C (AP intake). Solid savings and removes a single-point-of-failure, slot it after the revenue wins.

Opportunity	Type	Annual $	Effort	Priority
A. Inbound call recovery	Revenue	$66,000	M (3-4 wk)	1 (anchor)
D. Renewal/reactivation engine	Revenue	$48,000	S/M (2-3 wk)	2
B. Estimator quote assist	Revenue	$31,200	S/M (2 wk)	3
E. Kill dead stack	Savings	$8,000	S (1 wk)	4 (onboarding)
C. AP invoice intake	Savings	$15,600	M (3 wk)	5
TOTAL IDENTIFIED		**$168,800/yr**		

Total identified annual opportunity: $168,800. Against a $1,500 assessment fee, even if every one of my conservative assumptions is off by half you are still clearing six figures of recoverable value. I would rather you anchor on that floor than on a headline multiple.

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5. Recommended 90-Day Roadmap

A realistic sequence if we move forward. This is one person (me) embedded part-time, so it is paced for a single operator, not a 5-person agency promising everything at once.

Weeks 1-2 (Onboarding + quick wins). - Full tool-stack audit, credentials moved into a client-controlled vault. - Execute Opportunity E: cancel the dormant email tool, fix the broken form-to-CRM link immediately (this stops active bleeding on day one), flag Zapier for retirement. - Stand up call tracking so we get a real baseline answer rate before we change anything.

Weeks 3-5 (First revenue build). - Build Opportunity D (renewal/reactivation engine) in GHL. It is fast, recurring, and starts producing leads while the bigger build runs. - Build Opportunity B (estimator assist) in parallel since it is light. Get both estimators on the shared workflow.

Weeks 6-9 (Anchor build). - Build Opportunity A (AI inbound voice + intake layer, n8n integration, proper form pipeline with failure alerting). This is the big one. Test it against the baseline from week 2.

Weeks 10-12 (Cost build + report). - Build Opportunity C (AP invoice intake pipeline). - Retire Zapier once its live automations are confirmed running on n8n. - Deliver the first monthly executive report: what is live, measured answer-rate lift, leads recovered, contracts renewed, hours saved, dollars tracked against these estimates.

By day 90 the two highest-value items (A and D) are live and measurable, the quick wins are banked, and you have a dashboard answer to the question nobody could answer at the start: what is our AI and automation actually returning.

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6. What Working With Me Looks Like Next

This assessment is the diagnosis. The build and the ongoing management is the Fractional AI Officer retainer.

For a company Pioneer's size ($18M revenue, $10M-$30M band) the fit is the **Growth tier at $8,000/month**: 15 hours a week embedded as your AI department, biweekly cadence sitting in your leadership meetings, up to 15 systems managed, a monthly executive report that puts real numbers against everything running. Three-month minimum, month-to-month after that. You get CTO-level thinking on your AI and automation for less than the loaded cost of a single junior hire, and you do not have to manage a technical person, recruit one, or hope a generic agency cares about your business after the invoice clears.

The $1,500 you paid for this assessment credits in full toward your first month if you bring me on within 30 days. So your real first-month cost is $6,500, and the very first build on the roadmap (fixing the form link and standing up call tracking) starts paying that back in week one.

Here is the honest math. The retainer runs $96,000 a year. The opportunities in this report total $168,800 a year, conservatively, and several of them recur and compound. This is not close. The question is not whether the return is there. It is whether you want one person who owns all of it and is accountable for the number, or whether you want to keep paying $32K a year for a stack nobody is driving.

If it makes sense, the next step is simple: I send the scope document for the Growth tier, we lock the start date, and week one begins with the form fix and call tracking so you see movement immediately.

Eli

Adova Synapse. Fractional AI leadership for companies that cannot afford a CTO but cannot afford to fly blind.